

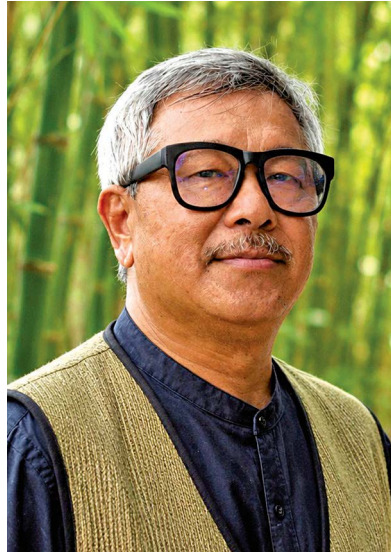
From Northeast India to Global Bamboo Leadership

As India advances toward the vision of a Viksit Bharat, sustainable development, climate resilience, and green enterprise are becoming central pillars of economic growth. Among the leaders contributing to this transformation is Kamesh SALAM, widely recognized as an Authority on Bamboo in South Asia and one of the most influential figures in the global bamboo sector.

Born in Manipur and professionally rooted in Assam, SALAM has dedicated more than three decades to transforming bamboo from a traditional resource into a strategic economic, environmental, and industrial asset. Widely regarded as one of the architects of Northeast India's bamboo growth story, he has played a pivotal role in building an integrated bamboo value chain that connects farmers, artisans, entrepreneurs, industries, investors, and policymakers.

As the Founder and CEO of Cane and Bamboo Value Chain Management (CanBoo), SALAM pioneered a comprehensive value-chain approach encompassing bamboo cultivation, processing, product development, enterprise creation, market access, and investment promotion. Through CanBoo, he has championed innovative applications of bamboo in sustainable construction, infrastructure, furniture, handicrafts, biochar, carbon sequestration, engineered bamboo products, and green manufacturing.

Founder of World Bamboo Day and former President of the World Bamboo Organization (WBO), SALAM made history as the first and only Asian to be elected President of WBO, the world's premier body dedicated to bamboo research, innovation, trade, and sustainable development.



“Bamboo is not merely a resource; it is a pathway to sustainable livelihoods, climate resilience, green infrastructure, and a more prosperous future for communities around the world.”

— Kamesh SALAM

Authority on Bamboo in South Asia |
Former President, World Bamboo
Organization (WBO) | First and Only
Asian President of WBO | CEO, CanBoo

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His influence extends beyond enterprise development. SALAM has contributed to Development Project Reports (DPRs), strategic plans, and sectoral initiatives under the National Bamboo Mission and served as a Member of its Apex Committee. He has been a strong advocate for improving the Ease of Doing Business in

Bamboo and has worked extensively on bamboo policy reforms, market development, and private-sector participation.

He played an important role in advocacy efforts that contributed to reforms culminating in the Indian Forest (Amendment) Ordinance, 2017, which removed major barriers to the cultivation and transit of bamboo grown outside forest areas, unlocking new opportunities for farmers and entrepreneurs.

SALAM has collaborated extensively with governments, research institutions, and international organizations including UNIDO, UNDP, INBAR, GIZ, ADB and others to promote bamboo enterprise development and green industrialization across South Asia.

A notable example of his vision is CanBoo's contribution to bamboo-inspired infrastructure and design initiatives at Guwahati International Airport Limited (GIAL), demonstrating how indigenous materials and local expertise can contribute to globally recognized infrastructure while showcasing the culture and sustainability ethos of Northeast India.

A recipient of the Outstanding Green Activist Award of India, SALAM continues to serve as a respected entrepreneur, policy advocate, and global bamboo ambassador. His journey from the bamboo-growing communities of Manipur and Assam to international leadership demonstrates how local knowledge, sustainable entrepreneurship, and visionary leadership can create solutions with global impact.